

Bilawal Ali

Cybersecurity Analyst | SOC | Threat Detection | Security Operations

Pakistan • Open to Relocation to UAE / Saudi Arabia / GCC • +92 344 3559788 • khooharobilawalali@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/bilawal-ali-0b0211245 • github.com/Bila-Ali • bila-ali.github.io

Professional Summary

Entry-level SOC Analyst candidate with a B.S. in Cyber Security from Mehran University of Engineering Technology (MUET), graduating December 2026. Hands-on experience monitoring and triaging 1,000+ security events daily across Windows and Linux environments using Wazuh SIEM, with additional experience in Splunk and ELK Stack. Investigated brute-force attacks, authentication anomalies, and lateral movement indicators; developed custom detection rules; configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) with automated response; analyzed IOCs; prepared incident reports for escalation; and mapped security events to MITRE ATT&CK. Seeking entry-level opportunities in SOC Operations, Cybersecurity Analysis, Security Operations, and IT Security.

Technical Skills

SOC & Security Operations: Security Monitoring, Alert Triage, Threat Detection, Incident Response, IOC Analysis, Threat Hunting, Log Analysis, Digital Forensics, Incident Escalation

SIEM & Monitoring: Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack, Kibana, Suricata, File Integrity Monitoring (FIM), Automated Response

Security Tools: Wireshark, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, Scapy

Cybersecurity: Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Web Application Security, Malware Analysis, Phishing Analysis, Security Automation

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, OWASP Top 10, Cyber Kill Chain

Programming & Systems: Python, Bash, Pandas, Flask, Streamlit, Machine Learning, Explainable AI, Windows, Linux, Kali Linux

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, Network Traffic Analysis, Firewalls

Professional Experience

SOC Analyst Intern

Feb 2026 – May 2026

Cyberster

Remote

- Monitored and triaged 1,000+ security events daily across Windows and Linux environments using Wazuh SIEM.
- Investigated brute-force attacks, authentication anomalies, lateral movement indicators, and unauthorized system changes.
- Developed and deployed 5+ custom Wazuh detection rules to improve alert coverage and threat detection.
- Configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) and automated response to detect unauthorized changes and block malicious IP addresses.
- Investigated Indicators of Compromise (IOCs), analyzed security alerts, and prepared structured incident reports for escalation.
- Mapped security events and attack techniques to MITRE ATT&CK to support threat analysis.

Red Team Intern

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

ITSOLERA Pvt Ltd

Remote

- Conducted authorized Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT) across 20+ web applications.
- Identified SQL Injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), CSRF, and broken authentication vulnerabilities.
- Used Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, and other security testing tools to assess application security weaknesses.
- Documented vulnerabilities with reproduction steps, severity assessments, evidence, and remediation recommendations.

Independent Security Researcher

Jan 2024 – Present

Freelance / Part-time

Remote

- Conducted security assessments of public web applications and APIs, focusing on application security and access-control vulnerabilities.
- Developed Python scripts for security testing, vulnerability analysis, and investigation workflows; responsibly disclosed findings with technical documentation and remediation recommendations.

Education

B.S. Cyber Security

Expected Dec 2026

Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET), Jamshoro, Pakistan

CGPA: 3.39 / 4.0

Selected Cybersecurity Projects

AI-Based PDF Malware Detection System

2026

- Developed a Python-based machine learning system for detecting potentially malicious PDF files using static security features and SHAP Explainable AI.

SOC & Threat Simulation Lab

2026

- Built a security monitoring lab integrating Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack, Suricata, and pfSense to generate and analyze security telemetry and practice alert investigation.

MailForensics Tool

2026

- Developed a Python and Streamlit DFIR utility for parsing .eml files, extracting Indicators of Compromise, and identifying phishing-related characteristics.

Certifications

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate • Google IT Support Professional Certificate • Google IT Automation with Python Professional Certificate • Cisco Junior Cybersecurity Analyst • Practical SOC Analyst T1/T2 Preparation Course – Udemy • Intro to Splunk • Cybersecurity Fundamentals Associate – OPSWAT • CEH (PFTP)

Leadership & Achievements

- **1st Place** – QUEST CTF Hackathon, 2026
- **Consolation Prize, Team Lead** – NADRA Bug Bounty Competition, 2026
- **Ranked 29th Nationally** – Ignite CTF National Hackathon
- Completed 150+ PortSwigger Web Security Academy labs and actively practice on Hack The Box and TryHackMe.
- **Cybersecurity Event Lead & Volunteer**, ACCESS~DENIED, MUET Cyber Security Department – contributed to challenge design and organization of the BSCYS CTF Hackathon 2026 and cybersecurity workshops.

Languages

English • Urdu • Sindhi